

MSc DISSERTATION / AEP
STUDENT – SUPERVISOR AGREEMENT FORM

Instructions:

Students to complete this form, and both student and supervisor to sign it. The student saves it as a PDF and then uploads to the relevant Blackboard unit any time up to the relevant deadline:

- Deadline for Supervisor Agreement Forms for individual dissertations: **Friday 29th May 2026.**
- Deadline for Supervisor Agreement Forms for group dissertations/AEPs/global challenges: **Tuesday 23rd June 2026.**

Student and supervisor to both keep a copy for their records.

Section 1a) Complete only for Individual Dissertations:

MSc Programme (including pathway if relevant)	
Name of student	Changle Zhao
Student number	2719338
Name of supervisor	Linh Duong

Section 1b) Complete only for Group Dissertations/AEPs/Global Challenges:

Group Name	
Student Names, ID numbers, and MSc Programmes (including pathway) e.g. Student 1: First name, Surname, ID, programme	
Name of supervisor	

Section 2) Complete for all dissertation types

Topic area
Artificial Intelligence (AI), Digital Customer Engagement, and Service Trust in the Global Domestic Cleaning Industry
Research Question
How do AI-enabled digital customer engagement touchpoints shape service trust in the global domestic cleaning industry?
AI Usage Level agreed with supervisor

AI will be used as a supporting tool for literature searching, idea development, language refinement, coding support, and structure improvement. It may also be used to support text analysis tasks such as keyword identification and sentiment analysis, where appropriate. It will not be used to generate fabricated data, replace critical analysis, or produce uncited academic content. All AI-assisted content and analysis will be reviewed, edited, and critically evaluated by the student in line with university guidelines.

Proposed research outline

This dissertation will examine how AI-enabled digital customer engagement touchpoints shape service trust in the global domestic cleaning industry. The study will combine a structured literature review with secondary online review analysis of publicly available customer reviews from domestic cleaning and home service platforms.

The dissertation will first introduce the increasing use of AI-enabled and digital tools such as online booking systems, chatbots, automated notifications, platform communication, rating systems, recommendation tools, and digital customer support in service industries. It will then review literature on AI-enabled customer engagement, digital customer engagement, service trust, platform-based services, online reviews, privacy concerns, and technology acceptance.

The study will use online customer reviews as secondary data to examine how customers describe trust-related experiences in domestic cleaning services. The research will focus on AI-relevant digital engagement touchpoints, including booking, communication, customer support, service recovery, ratings and reviews, platform transparency, and complaint handling. The empirical analysis will compare trust-related themes across three regional contexts: China as the primary Asian case, the United States as the primary American case, and selected European developed markets such as the United Kingdom, France, and Germany.

Based on the literature review and online review analysis, the dissertation will develop a conceptual framework explaining how AI-enabled digital engagement may strengthen service trust through convenience, responsiveness, transparency, reliability, personalisation, and perceived service quality. It will also discuss potential negative effects, including privacy concerns, lack of human touch, poor service recovery, platform opacity, hidden fees, and weak accountability.

Justification

The domestic cleaning industry depends strongly on trust because service providers often enter customers' private homes and handle sensitive personal spaces. Customers need to trust not only the individual cleaner, but also the platform or company that arranges the service, manages communication, handles payment, responds to complaints, and provides service recovery.

This topic is important because domestic cleaning and home service industries are increasingly managed through digital platforms and app-based systems. AI-enabled customer engagement is becoming more relevant to online booking, customer support, automated communication, service matching, personalised recommendations, review systems, and complaint handling. These digital touchpoints can improve convenience and responsiveness, but they can also create concerns about privacy, transparency, reliability, and reduced human interaction.

Existing research has examined AI customer service, customer engagement, and trust in general service contexts. However, less attention has been given to how AI-enabled digital engagement may shape trust in domestic cleaning and home service contexts, where trust is especially important due to safety, privacy, and access to the customer's home. By analysing online customer reviews across China, the United States, and selected European markets, this dissertation addresses a relevant gap and provides a business analytics perspective on service trust in digitally mediated domestic cleaning services.

China is selected as the primary Asian case because it has a large domestic service market, a mature digital platform economy, and available online customer review sources related to home cleaning and household services. The study does not claim that China represents Asia as a whole;

rather, it uses China as a major Asian context for comparison with the United States and selected European developed markets. This sampling approach helps keep the research scope manageable while allowing cross-regional comparison.

Methodology

This study will adopt a literature-informed secondary data analysis research design. It will combine a structured review of academic literature with the analysis of publicly available online customer reviews from domestic cleaning and home service platforms.

The literature review will examine existing research on AI-enabled customer engagement, digital customer engagement, customer service technologies, service trust, platform trust, online reviews, privacy concerns, and domestic cleaning/home service industries. This will provide the theoretical foundation for understanding how AI-enabled digital engagement touchpoints may influence service trust.

The empirical part of the study will use secondary data collected from publicly available online customer reviews. The data will be drawn from platforms and review sources across three regional contexts. China will be used as the primary Asian case, using sources such as Meituan/Dianping, Tian'e Daojia, Daojia App, JD Home Services, and relevant consumer review or complaint platforms where available. The United States will be used as the primary American case, using sources such as Homeaglow, Taskrabbit, Yelp, Trustpilot, and BBB complaints where relevant. Europe will include selected developed markets, such as the United Kingdom, France, and Germany, using sources such as Housekeep, Fantastic Services, Helping, Trustpilot, and other relevant review platforms.

The dataset is expected to include approximately 300 to 600 online customer reviews, depending on data availability and ethical approval. The collected data will include review text, star rating where available, review date where available, platform or company name, country/region, and coded trust-related themes.

The data will be analysed using business analytics methods, including descriptive statistics, sentiment analysis, keyword frequency analysis, thematic coding, and cross-regional comparison. The analysis will focus on trust-related themes such as reliability, responsiveness, professionalism, safety, privacy concerns, booking convenience, communication quality, platform transparency, service recovery, refund and cancellation issues, and platform accountability.

No primary data collection, such as surveys or interviews, will be conducted. As the study uses publicly available secondary data, ethical considerations will include anonymising any personal information, avoiding identifiable customer details, complying with platform terms where applicable, and obtaining university research ethics approval before data collection begins.

Timetable

Week 1: Finalise the research question, confirm the research scope, and refine the focus on AI-enabled digital customer engagement and service trust.

Week 2: Search and collect academic literature on AI-enabled customer engagement, digital customer engagement, service trust, platform trust, online reviews, and domestic cleaning/home service platforms.

Week 3: Identify and confirm suitable secondary data sources, including online customer reviews from China, the United States, and selected European markets.

Week 4: Prepare the research ethics application, including the secondary data collection plan, data anonymisation approach, and intended analysis methods.

Week 5: Write the introduction chapter, including the research background, research problem, research aim, research question, and significance of the study.

Week 6: Write the literature review chapter, focusing on AI-enabled customer engagement, digital service platforms, service trust, customer experience, privacy concerns, and domestic cleaning services.

Week 7: Write the methodology chapter, explaining the secondary data research design, data sources, sampling approach, coding strategy, ethical considerations, and business analytics methods.

Week 8: Collect and prepare the online review dataset, including organising review text, ratings, dates, platform names, regional categories, and initial trust-related codes.

Week 9: Analyse the data using descriptive statistics, sentiment analysis, keyword frequency analysis, thematic coding, and cross-regional comparison.

Week 10: Write the data analysis and findings chapter, presenting key patterns in trust-related customer experiences across China, the United States, and selected European markets.

Week 11: Write the discussion and conclusion chapter, linking the findings to the literature, conceptual framework, theoretical implications, managerial implications, limitations, and future research.

Week 12: Edit and proofread all chapters, check referencing style, revise according to supervisor feedback, finalise formatting, and prepare the final submission.

Agreed Scheduled Delivery of **Draft Chapters** [taking into account supervisor annual leave]

Chapter 1: Introduction draft will be submitted to the supervisor by 20 June 2026.

Chapter 2: Literature Review draft will be submitted to the supervisor by 5 July 2026.

Chapter 3: Methodology draft will be submitted to the supervisor by 20 July 2026.

Chapter 4: Data Analysis and Findings draft will be submitted to the supervisor by 5 August 2026.

Chapter 5: Discussion and Conclusion draft will be submitted to the supervisor by 18 August 2026.

Full dissertation draft will be submitted to the supervisor by 25 August 2026.

Final revised dissertation will be completed by 30 August 2026, after receiving supervisor feedback

Terms and Conditions of the Student-Supervisor Agreement:

1. Research proposal

The proposed research to be conducted by the student is set out in this form. Any significant deviation from the plan for work described here should be discussed and agreed in a formal supervision meeting. It is the responsibility of the student to inform supervisors of any change to the plan of work.

2. Supervision

The maximum period of direct supervision provided to the student is five hours. The student is responsible for making the best use of this resource. A meeting schedule will be discussed at the first meeting. Supervisors will inform students when their annual leave will be taken over the summer period. Notes should be kept on the discussions and decisions made in supervision meetings. Best practice is for students to send notes on the discussions and decisions made in supervision meetings to supervisors by email immediately after meetings.

3. Draft Chapters

The supervisor should provide written feedback either within 10 working days for each submission of the draft - chapter by chapter - or within 15 working days for the draft of the whole dissertation. The protocol for receiving written feedback will be discussed during the first meeting. It is essential that students keep to the agreed schedule for delivery of drafts otherwise feedback and/or delivery within timeframes may be impacted due to supervisor leave or other commitments.

4. AI Usage Level agreed with the Supervisor

The Business School Board of Studies committee has agreed a blanket approach to allowing student AI usage within our PGT dissertation units:

- Level 2, or 3 *with specific parameters set by the supervisor*, for the Planning and Research stage.
- Level 2 maximum for the Writing Up stage.

Academic guidance on AI categories can be found here: [Using AI in Assessment | Bristol Institute For Learning and Teaching | University of Bristol](#). The Supervisor agrees to discuss and review the authorised AI Usage level for the dissertation work. The Supervisor will also confirm the agreed AI usage level via a form which will be circulated separately.

5. Research Ethics

The supervisor agrees to discuss and review the Ethics Form proposed by the student. The form needs to be completed in OREMS by the student, supervisor, and Ethics Academic Checker before submission to the School Research Ethics Committee (REC). The supervisor and Ethics Academic Checker will indicate whether the application is considered pre-approved or needs further review by the School REC. In all cases, formal approval is issued by the School REC, and students must not begin any data collection before receiving the approval letter. This applies to both primary and secondary studies. The ethics process must be fully completed by the end of June. Failure to gain full approval for your ethics application before beginning data collection will constitute an ethics breach

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and will need to be formally investigated. It is also the student's responsibility to include the Ethics Form, approval letter, and any additional documentation in the dissertation appendices.

6. Agreement

The Student and the Supervisor agree to work within this agreement.

This agreement must be signed * by both parties and uploaded to Blackboard by the end of June. Copies should also be kept by the student and supervisor, so that the schedule as set out can be followed.

We have read and agree to the Terms and Conditions of this agreement.

Signature of Supervisor:Linh Duong..... Date: 29 / 05 / 2026

Signature of Student(s): *Changle Zhao* Date: 28/ 05 / 2026
..... Date: ____ / ____ / ____
..... Date: ____ / ____ / ____
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Notes on filling out the form

Subject Area

Your dissertation must be relevant to your named study programme and relate to the topic you have chosen (where relevant). You should not be writing a dissertation on a subject you haven't studied. You can, however, draw on your first degree or past work experience.

Title for the Proposed Research

What is going to be researched? This might take the form of a research question or questions to be investigated, or a hypothesis to be tested.

Try to focus the title as much as possible and be succinct. Be specific, for instance: focus on an industry or a geographical area; name a company as an example or illustration or name a particular theoretical framework; or use a statement that you wish to challenge or a problem you want to address.

Note that the title can (and normally does) change over the course of your research, however a clear focus at the start makes the research process easier and the resulting dissertation is usually of a higher standard, normally because it is well structured. Indeed, you will be marked on the quality and appropriateness of your research question. Your supervisor will help you further with your research question and title during your first meeting. You should come to the first meeting with ideas you have developed.

Proposal Outline

Justification: explain why the research is important.

This should take the form of a short critique of the main themes and controversies in the relevant literature as they relate to the research problem to be investigated. Identify gaps in the literature or problems eg with past methods of investigation that need to be addressed. You should also include your own reasons for wanting to study the area and why the results might be useful to you and others.

Outline the research methods you plan to use.

Briefly explain how you plan to carry out the research. How will you design any primary research? Will this overcome previous methodological weaknesses or follow examples of others in the field? What problems do you foresee and how do you plan to overcome them? You may have received methods training via a previous unit.

Conclude by giving a (draft) timetable of your research.

Include significant events (such as completion of on-line interviews or chapters) and set deadlines for yourself and in relation to planned delivery of draft chapters to your supervisor for comment. Take your supervisor's annual leave into consideration as you plan your timetable.